Ivy Wanjiku Wanjiru

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

PERSONAL STATEMENT

Backend-focused Software Developer who turns messy, real-world problems into working systems. I debug production Django applications, build REST APIs that connect cleanly to React and TypeScript frontends, and ship computer vision pipelines (YOLOv8, OCR, CLIP) that automate work previously done by hand. I care about outcomes over activity: fewer recurring bugs, faster releases, and code that still works after I've moved on to the next problem.

EXPERIENCE

Junior Developer at Joombaah
April 2025 to Present

- Integrated YOLOv8 object detection into the existing OCR- and CLIP-embedding-based computer vision pipeline, adding automated detection of 6–10 new visual signals per ad creative (including logo placement, product count, and people/vehicle presence) and turning a multi-hour manual tagging batch into an automated pass that runs in minutes.
- Built brand intelligence workflows for raw-variant discovery, normalization, and deduplication, cleaning and structuring over 50,000 ad records for downstream analysis.
- Designed and maintained REST APIs and authentication flows powering the platform's AI-assisted creative studio, including image generation, refinement, and ad copy generation.
- Debugged and resolved production issues across the Django REST Framework backend, PostgreSQL/MySQL databases, and React frontend, tracing root causes without breaking existing functionality.
- Supported production operations through Docker-based deployment, Celery task queues, and CI/CD pipeline management, with hands-on exposure to Kubernetes.

Software Development Intern at Joombaah
January 2025 to April 2025

- Onboarded to the Adverts Explorer Django/Python codebase and shipped data extraction and pipeline processes in Python and Java without disrupting existing functionality.
- Identified and fixed code inefficiencies during debugging, building a practical, root-cause approach to problem-solving that carried into the full-time role.
- Collaborated with the team to refine specifications and align delivery with client requirements, using Git for version control.

PROJECTS

LifeShine
Home-based caregiving platform for the Kenyan market, designed and built end to end as sole developer: Django REST Framework backend, React frontend, and full deployment to a TrueHost Kenya VPS. Owned the project from architecture through QA to handover, with no other engineers on the build.

Fanikisha
Dairy farmer loan portal connecting Django REST Framework APIs to a Next.js frontend, replacing a paper-based loan application process with authenticated digital workflows for a real-world fintech use case.
Project link: View project

ReverseTaka
Kotlin/Android app connecting informal artisans with recycling companies to trade non-recyclable clothing, with a dashboard that replaces manual record-keeping for recyclers tracking sales.
Project link: View project

CONTACT

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SKILLS

Backend Development
Python, Django, Django REST Framework, Java, REST APIs, authentication
Building APIs and business logic for production systems.

Frontend Development
React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS
Connecting backend services to responsive interfaces.

Databases & Data
PostgreSQL, MySQL, Django ORM, SQL, ETL, data pipelines
Designing schemas and optimizing queries across the stack.

Mobile Development
Kotlin, Android, RecyclerView, ViewBinding
Building native Android applications end to end.

Computer Vision & AI
YOLOv8, OpenCV, OCR, CLIP embeddings, AI-assisted content generation
Applying vision models to real data-extraction problems.

DevOps & Tools
Git, GitHub, Docker, Celery, CI/CD, Render, Vercel, Kubernetes (hands-on exposure)
Deploying and maintaining applications in production.

EDUCATION

AkiraChix codeHive
Diploma in Information Technology
January 2024 to November 2024

RELEVANT COURSES

- Backend Development
- Frontend Web & Mobile Development
- Data & Software Architecture
- Product Management
- UX Research and UI/UX Design